

A stable v 2.6.26-based RT Linux released

The Open Source Automation Development Lab (OSADL) has announced that the 'latest stable' version (2.6.26-r16) of real-time mainline Linux (a.k.a. PREEMPT_RT) is now based on kernel version 2.6.26, after successfully testing it in a wide variety of kernel configurations and on many different platforms.

Apart from maintenance fixes, the 'latest stable' version incorporates two significant features: device tree support and improved kernel cache management of the video buffer. According to the release information, the device tree is, "...a (simple) flat data structure containing information about the devices of a given computer board. The device tree source (DTS) is compiled using the device tree compiler (DTC), and the resulting device tree binary (DTB) is integrated into the boot image. The device tree facilitates board configuration and is required for the merging of the two PPC architecture implementations, ppc and powerpc."

The improved kernel cache management of the video buffer, on the other hand, "...makes it possible for the first time to use hardware-accelerated graphics in a real-time system without any side effects of graphics operations on the real-time capabilities of the system. There is only a minor restriction: some latencies in the range of several milliseconds, occur when the graphics board is initialised for the first time. Later on, switching to and from graphics or even restarting the X server does not produce any more latencies. Since the initialisation of the graphics board can be done at boot time before the real-time critical application is started, this restriction is normally not significant." For more details visit www.osadl.org.

Azingo Mobile 2.0: A complete touch- and Web-enabled OS

Open mobile OS company Azingo has announced Azingo Mobile 2.0, a Linux-based platform that includes the Azingo Browser, Azingo Web Runtime, Azingo Application Suite, and Azingo Active Homescreen. Azingo Mobile 2.0 offers a comprehensive UI toolkit enabling a full touch user experience and Web widgets that claim to leverage device-specific services like telephony, messaging, multimedia and location-based services through the Azingo Web Runtime.

Azingo Mobile 2.0 includes all of the software, development tools, documentation and training required to design and commercialise new mobile phone products. This new platform is based on the LiMo Foundation R1 Reference Implementation. Manufacturers licensing Azingo Mobile 2.0 will receive the Azingo Browser, Azingo Web Runtime, Azingo Active Homescreen and the Azingo Application Suite.

Azingo's Active Homescreen radically extends the capabilities of a conventional phone homescreen by allowing users to add and organise pertinent, real-time information from the Internet and their phone, for fast, simple access. The Azingo Active Homescreen was designed to mimic the familiar computer desktop experience through features such as a wider, scrolling homescreen area, drag and drop, shortcuts, folders, and widgets. Users also have one-touch access to content on their handset, including native, Web, or Flash Lite applications, contacts, photos, music, videos, and messages.

The Azingo Applications Suite is available for all Linux-based mobile platforms. The Suite includes the following applications: Azingo Mobile Entertainment, Azingo Mobile Productivity, Azingo Mobile Communications, and Azingo Mobile System Applications.



VMware View Open Client goes LGPL

VMware has announced the release of an open source client for the virtual desktop infrastructure called VMware View Open Client. VMware View supposedly enables IT organisations to safely host user desktops in the data centres, while letting users access their personalised desktop environments from almost any device, at any time. Now, the virtualisation vendor is providing VMware View Open Client for partners, enabling them to use VMware View source code to

optimise their products to deliver rich, personalised virtual desktops.

VMware View Open Client is available under the GNU Lesser General Public License version 2.1 (LGPL v2.1) and is accessible from code.google.com/p/vmware-view-open-client. Some of the features included in this release support secure tunnelling using SSL, two factor authentication with RSA SecurID, Novell SUSE Linux Enterprise Thin Client Add-On RPM package and a full command-line interface.